

5757 South University 036



[If you have comments, send additional information](#)

Address: 5757 South University Avenue

Year Construction: 1928

Year Acquired: 2008

Architect: Herbert Hugh Riddle

Gross Square Feet: 111,145

Primary Use: Administrative Office

Design Zone: Main Quadrangle

Last Major Renovation:

2012-2013

Comments:

The University acquired building with the intention to fully renovate for Department of Economics and Becker Friedman Institute; The Adaptive Reuse of 5757 South University consists of the renovation of the current Chicago Theological Seminary building that fronts 58th Street from Woodlawn to University Avenues adjacent to the University of Chicago Main Quadrangles.

REGULATORY STATUS

National Register:

NR Historic District:

Hyde Park-Kenwood Historic District

Chicago HRS Color Code: Orange

1 - Site

Land Ownership Status: Owned

Location - Physical:

No comment

Location - Program Adjacency:

No comment

Location Comment:

Originally a self-contained complex of student rooms, classrooms, offices, library and chapel for the seminary which had a changing affiliation with the University Divinity School.

2 - Adaptability

Construction Type:

Unknown

Accessibility:

Entrance/Bathrooms - Partial

Floor-to-Floor Height:

1st Floor: 12'-10", 2nd through 4th Floors: 9'-10"

Structural Capability:

Structural analysis required - structural drawings are available.

Adaptability Exterior:

Distinctive original character would require careful analysis of adaptation to different uses.

Adaptability Interior:

Majority of building spaces readily adaptable. Public spaces such as the chapels and library have distinctive character which might limit adaptation.

Adaptability Physical Features:

No comment

Adaptability Structure:

Reinforced concrete construction would allow for reconfiguration.

3 - Building Envelope

Roof Type: No Data

Exterior Facade:

Masonry

Exterior Base: Limestone

Exterior Trim: Limestone and brick

4 - Heritage and Historic

Landmark Status:

no

National Register:

NR Historic District:

Hyde Park-Kenwood Historic District

NR Comments:

Architectural significance, item #59 on district nomination form

CHRS Comments:

Possesses potentially significant architectural features.

Heritage - Exterior:

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Academic Gothic Revival exterior character executed in brick is in distinct contrast to predominant limestone campus. Exterior decorative features are substantially intact including original windows (some existing stained glass were removed for relocation to new CTS building), carved stone ornament, copper cupola at main chapel, and prominent masonry tower.

Heritage - Interior:

Original dormitory rooms were converted to offices and classrooms in previous renovations and feature quarry tile flooring, painted plaster walls, and simple wood doors and casing.

Significant Spaces Identified:

No Comment

Heritage Culture Elements:

Significant theological figures who have attended CTS include the Rev. Jesse Jackson and those who have received honorary degrees include the Rev. Martin Luther King, Jr. and Archbishop Desmond Tutu.

Architectural Awards Certification:

None identified

Heritage and History - General Comments:

Built in 1926 for Chicago Theological Seminary, originally founded in 1856. Major figures connected to the building included newspaper published Victor Lawson, social reformer Graham Taylor

5 - Sustainability

Certifications:

none identified

Window Last Replacement:

No Data

Weather Stripping:

N.A.

R Value Roof/Wall:

N.A.

Systems:

Deficiencies: